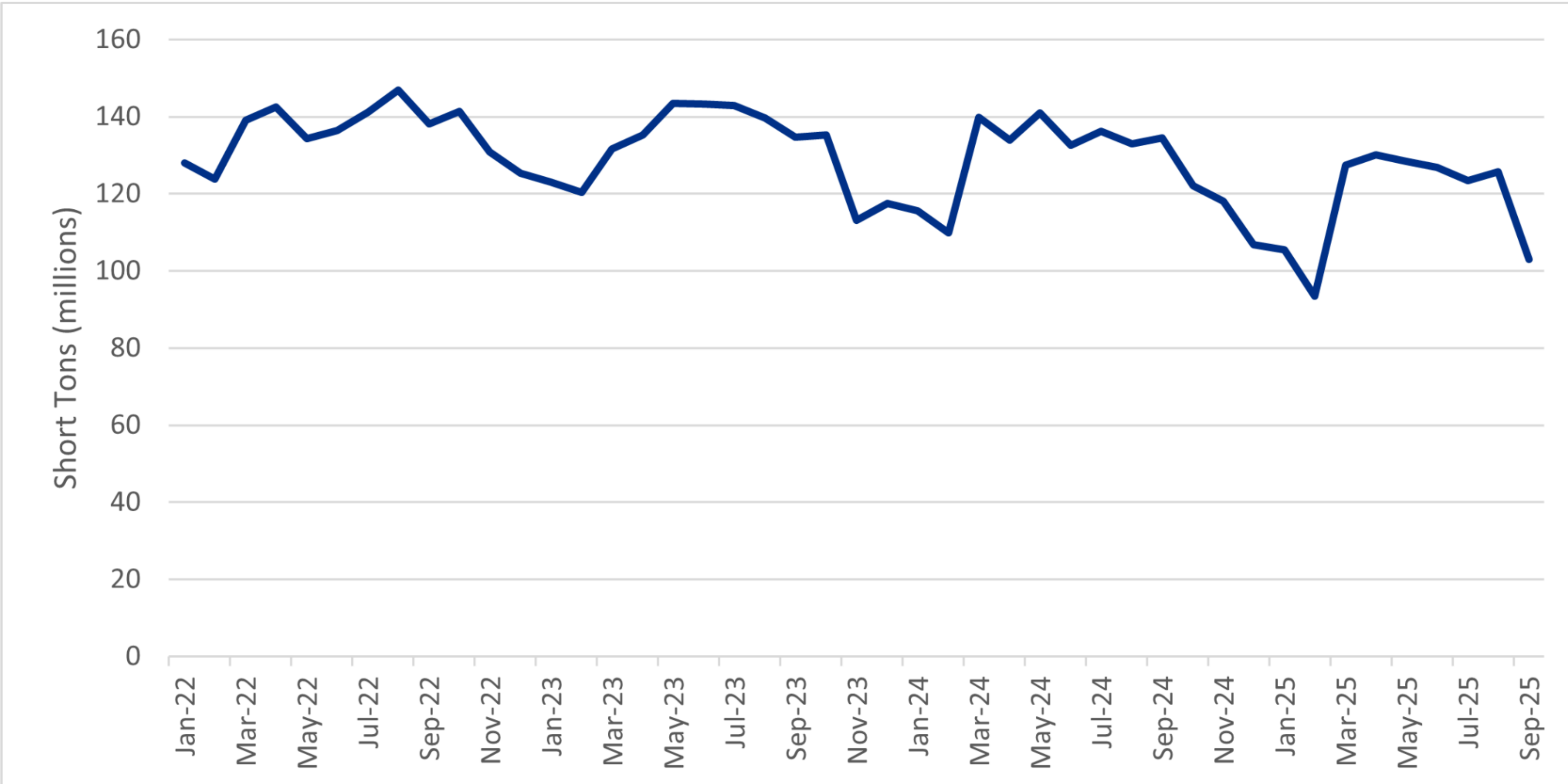

1. Background

Figure 24b presents a **time-series line chart** showing monthly U.S. waterborne tonnage from January 2022 through September 2025. The y-axis shows short tons (millions) ranging from 0 to 160 million. The series shows repeated seasonal highs (mid-year) and lows (late-year), with notable downward spikes around late 2023 and early 2025, followed by partial recovery.

PASS

2. Text Contrast

All textual elements use dark gray/black on white, providing excellent contrast. Tick labels, rotated date labels, and the y-axis title all meet WCAG 4.5:1. Contrast evaluations: Estimated WCAG Contrast Ratios: • Navy line (#0A2A63 approx.) vs white: ~8.5:1 • Light gray grid lines vs white: ~2.4:1 • Dark gray/black text vs white background: 12–14:1 Navy line and labels exceed minimum 3:1 for graphical elements. Light gray grid lines fall below text contrast requirements but comply with **non-text decoration** rules.
PASS

3. Graphic (Line) Contrast

The navy data line is thick, crisp, and visually dominant against the white background. Grid lines are subtle and do not obscure the main data path. No clutter or overlapping annotations.
PASS

4. Color-Blind Accessibility

Only one line is present; thus, color-blind accessibility is inherently satisfied. The solid-line encoding ensures interpretable shape independent of color perception.
PASS

5. OCR / Text Size

Labels, numbers, and date strings are sufficiently large and clearly spaced. OCR engines can read rotated text because individual characters retain consistent vertical spacing.
PASS

6. Blur & DPI

The chart appears sharp and artifact-free. For congressional printing, 300 DPI export is recommended to preserve gridline and stroke fidelity.
PASS

7. Alt Text Recommendation

" Line chart showing U.S. monthly waterborne tonnage from January 2022 to September 2025. Values fluctuate between 120 and 150 million tons early on, dip to around 110 million in early 2023, rise to the mid-140s in mid-2023, decline sharply late 2023, partially recover mid-2024, drop again around early 2025, then rise toward mid-2025 before falling sharply again by September 2025. "
PASS